



Assessment Brief

Module title:	Total Quality Management in Health and Care
Module code:	HCM6003
Assignment title:	Quality Analysis Report
Assignment format:	Analytical report with a strategic improvement plan
Word/time limit:	3000 Words
File type	Doc file
Percentage of final grade	This assignment is worth 100% of your final grade for this module.
Submission deadline	See module iLearn page for date of submission
Grade release	You will normally receive your provisional grade and feedback within 20 working days of the submission deadline

Useful terms:

Learning outcomes (LOs)	The skills and knowledge that you should be able to show in your work.
Rubric/ Marking Matrix	A set of rules or guidelines used to grade or assess work.

[2756]

Task summary:

For this task, you must produce: Quality analysis report (3000 Words).

- Compile a TQM analysis report, including a quality improvement and maintenance plan.
- This TQM analysis must be specifically centred on the quality measures implemented within a selected health or social care service. The introduction should clearly outline the chosen department, service, or system, including contextual details such as its location, type of provision, and operational scope.
- Where the service is based in the UK, reference **must be made** to the most **recent CQC report** to inform the analysis of quality standards, areas for improvement, and regulatory compliance.
- If the chosen service is **located outside the UK**, equivalent regulatory and quality assurance documentation from the relevant national health authority or governing body should be consulted and referenced to ensure a comparable standard of evaluation.
- At this level of study, your ability to communicate complex information and approaches will be assessed. You should take responsibility to identify the service of choice and the direction of your work yourself.
- You should link your ideas explored in the analysis and associated improvement and maintenance plan to relevant theories and frameworks explored in the module. Doing so demonstrates a deeper understanding of how quality improvement is conceptualised and applied in real-world health or social care contexts.

Task 1: Service Overview and Existing Quality Measures (approx. 750 Words)

- Clearly describe the health or social care service being analysed, including its purpose, key functions, and regulatory or quality assurance context.
- Critically evaluate how the service delivers safe, effective, person-centred, timely, efficient, and equitable care using the IOM's Six Domains of Quality, and link identified strengths and limitations to improvement tools such as PDCA or Kaizen.
- Apply a recognised quality framework (e.g., Donabedian's Structure–Process–Outcome model or Deming's 14 Points) to assess service effectiveness and the role of leadership, staff development, and governance in supporting continuous quality improvement.
- For UK-based services, integrate evidence from the most recent CQC report (Safe, Effective, Caring, Responsive, Well-Led). For international contexts, refer to an appropriate quality assurance or regulatory body. For UK services, link directly to findings from the CQC report (e.g. Safe, Effective, Caring, Responsive, Well-Led).

LO 1

Critically analyse the need for care settings to achieve the best possible outcome for service users using a 'Total Quality Management' approach.

LO 3

Critically discuss the management of continuous quality improvement in health and care settings.

Task 2: Analysis of Current and Future Quality Measures (approx. 1000 Words)

- This task involves a **critical evaluation** of how the service manages quality, using a range of models.
- Select and justify one primary non-financial model (e.g. SERVQUAL or Baldrige) for in-depth analysis, with brief reference to a second model for comparative context.
- Select one primary multidimensional model (e.g. Balanced Scorecard or Strategy Maps) for in-depth analysis to demonstrate a holistic view of quality performance and its alignment with organisational objectives.
- Outline how ISO 9001 supports process standardisation and compliance, using a relevant healthcare example to illustrate associated benefits.
- Propose one relevant financial model (e.g. Cost-Benefit Analysis or Budget Impact Analysis) to evaluate quality planning and informed resource allocation.
- Use a recognised problem-solving framework (e.g. Root Cause Analysis) to critically identify a quality or performance issue and inform long-term planning through appropriate investment appraisal.

LO 2

Critically discuss and apply a range of strategic planning models to assess the viability of a health and care business.

LO 4

Evaluate the use of problem solving, investment appraisal, non-financial and multidimensional models of performance management.

Task 3: Improvement and Maintenance Plans (approx. 750 Words)

This section requires you to design both a quality improvement plan and a maintenance plan, **informed by your findings in Task 2.**

- Use TQM and continuous improvement tools (e.g. Pareto Analysis, Fishbone Diagrams, Lean Six Sigma) to diagnose root causes and prioritise targeted improvement actions.
- Define 1–2 SMART objectives to structure your improvement efforts.
- Use a Driver Diagram to visualise how change will be implemented.
- The maintenance plan should focus on critical systems or equipment (e.g. hoists, building infrastructure) and ensure safety, compliance, and service continuity.
- Embed continuous quality improvement (CQI) principles and ensure all plans align with the organisation's strategic goals.

LO 3

Critically discuss the management of continuous quality improvement in health and care settings.

LO 5

Graduate attribute: Discipline expertise: Knowledge and understanding of chosen field. Possess a range of skills to operate within this sector, have a keen awareness of current developments in working practice being well positioned to respond to change.

You will be assessed on:

- Your **explanation** of the department, service, and/or system you are analysing and the quality measures currently in place (approx. 750 words)
- Your **analysis** of the current measures, considering problem solving, investment appraisal, non-financial, and multidimensional models of performance management (approx. 1000 words)
- Your **improvement or maintenance plan**, considering the management of continuous quality improvement in health and care settings (approx. 750 words)
- How your plan **links to relevant theories and frameworks** for TQM (approx. 500 words)

Your assignment should include:

You must not include your name in your submission because Arden University operates anonymous marking, which means that markers should not be aware of the identity of the student. However, please do not forget to include your **STU number**.

Title Page Include:

- Student number
- Module name
- Submission deadline
- Exact word count
- Report title

Executive Summary (*Not included in word count*)

This one-page summary should:

- Outline the purpose and scope of the report
- Identify the health or social care setting analysed (UK or international)
- Summarise key findings from each task (TQM, strategy, improvement, performance)
- Highlight current quality measures, referencing the CQC report or equivalent
- Briefly present the main recommendations and anticipated outcomes

Contents Page

- Provide a table listing all sections and their corresponding page numbers for easy navigation.

Main Body

Organise the body under headings

- Task 1- Service Overview and Quality Evaluation
- Task 2 - Strategic Analysis of Current and Future Quality Measures
- Task 3 - Continuous Quality Improvement and Maintenance Planning with Theoretical and Strategic Alignment

Conclusion

- Summarise the main findings and reaffirm the importance of a TQM approach for improving service quality and outcomes.

Reference List

- Title the page “Reference list” (centre aligned)
- List all sources alphabetically, and chronologically within authors
- Use Arden Harvard referencing style throughout

Appendices *(If needed)*

- Include supporting documents (e.g. CQC reports, charts) clearly labelled and referenced in the text.

Please note that tutors will use the assessment criteria set out below in assessing your work.

Learning outcomes (LO)

By completing this assessment, you will have shown and be assessed on all five of the learning outcomes:

LO 1

Critically analyse the need for care settings to achieve the best possible outcome for service users using a ‘Total Quality Management’ approach.

LO 2

Critically discuss and apply a range of strategic planning models to assess the viability of a health and care business.

LO 3

Critically discuss the management of continuous quality improvement in health and care settings.

LO 4

Evaluate the use of problem solving, investment appraisal, non-financial and multidimensional models of performance management.

LO 5

Graduate attribute: Discipline expertise: Knowledge and understanding of chosen field. Possess a range of skills to operate within this sector, have a keen awareness of current developments in working practice being well positioned to respond to change.

You will be graded based on how well you meet these learning outcomes.

Your marker will use a rubric/ marking matrix to grade your work, and you can access this by clicking on the submission portal.

Guidelines and policies

You can find links to more useful information about the assignment and university policies below.

Word/time limit policy

[Click here to view the Arden University word count/time limit policy](#)

Referencing guidelines

[Click here for Harvard referencing guidelines](#)

Please follow the referencing guidelines that are appropriate for your degree programme. If you are unsure which you should be using, please contact your module team.

Academic integrity and misconduct policy

[Click here to view Arden University's policy on academic integrity and misconduct](#)

Statement on use of artificial intelligence on assessment

[Click here to view Arden University's statement on the use of artificial intelligence on assessment](#)

Support information

[Click here to view guidance on how to apply for short-term extensions](#)

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